



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 14

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Biscuit Joiner & Pocket Hole Jig Safety

OVERVIEW:

Biscuit joiners and pocket hole jigs are joinery tools used constantly in casework, cabinet assembly, and furniture fabrication. Both tools drive a blade or bit rapidly into the workpiece. Both require the workpiece to be secured before the tool engages, and both can cause serious injuries when the setup is

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. The biscuit joiner uses a spinning blade — similar to a small circular saw blade — that plunges rapidly into the workpiece when you press the tool forward. If the fence is not fully seated against the work surface and the workpiece is not clamped, the tool can walk sideways when it plunges, causing the blade to contact your hand or arm. Always clamp the workpiece before every
2. Before making a plunge cut with a biscuit joiner, look carefully at where your free hand is positioned. Many operators hold the workpiece with their free hand on the edge of the board — right in the path of where the blade would exit if something went wrong. Move your free hand to the top surface or use a clamp. If you would not be comfortable with the blade exiting where your hand is,
3. Pocket hole jig drilling requires the drill bit to travel through the wood at an angle. The bit is under lateral pressure during the cut, which can cause it to flex and break suddenly if the workpiece shifts or if the bit is dull or worn. Always use the drill guide built into the jig and ensure the workpiece is clamped into the jig fully before starting the drill. Replace pocket hole
4. When using either tool, disconnect power before making any adjustments to depth settings, fences, or stops. A biscuit joiner blade spinning at idle speed can still cause a serious laceration. Make it a habit — adjust, then plug in, never the other way around.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is the procedure for securing a workpiece in a biscuit joiner setup on a narrow piece?
Q2: How do you know when a pocket hole drill bit needs to be replaced?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Clamp or secure the workpiece firmly before every cut or bore
- Keep the fence firmly against the workpiece before plunging
- Inspect biscuit blades regularly for cracks or missing carbide
- Pocket hole jigs: keep fingers well away from the drill path
- Disconnect power before making any adjustments to fences or guides

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 14

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
01		click to sign	16		click to sign
02		click to sign	17		click to sign
03		click to sign	18		click to sign
04		click to sign	19		click to sign
05		click to sign	20		click to sign
06		click to sign	21		click to sign
07		click to sign	22		click to sign
08		click to sign	23		click to sign
09		click to sign	24		click to sign
10		click to sign	25		click to sign
11		click to sign	26		click to sign
12		click to sign	27		click to sign
13		click to sign	28		click to sign
14		click to sign	29		click to sign
15		click to sign	30		click to sign